

Question:

A baby is born after the 32nd gestational week by cesarean delivery. The mother suffered from gestational diabetes; however, she had no other pregnancy-related diseases and was otherwise healthy. The baby has a blood pressure of 100/58 mm Hg, heart rate of 104/min, and oxygen saturation of 88%. The child has tachypnea, subcostal and intercostal retractions, nasal flaring, and cyanosis. The cyanosis is responding well to initial administration of oxygen. The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)
- B. Tracheoesophageal fistula
- C. Pneumonia
- D. Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The neonate is born post-term (32 nd gestational week) via cesarean section due to the mother's gestational diabetes , which is a risk factor for NRDS .

- The neonate shows signs of respiratory distress , including tachypnea , retractions , nasal flaring , and cyanosis that improves with oxygen .

- The neonate has no issues with feeding , as the nasogastric tube placement was successful , and there is no mention of issues with swallowing or feeding .

- The other conditions (Tracheoesophageal fistula , pneumonia , and congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt) are less likely because the main issue appears to be respiratory rather than gastrointestinal or infective . Additionally , there is no indication of cyanosis being persistent or unresponsive to oxygen , which would be expected in more severe forms of heart anomalies or serious infections .

- The most common cause of respiratory distress in a neonate , especially one with a history of maternal gestational diabetes , is NRDS due to insufficient surfactant production in the lungs , leading to alveolar collapse and poor gas exchange , which improves with oxygen administration .

Answer Options :

- A . Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)
- B . Tracheoesophageal fistula
- C . Pneumonia
- D . Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt

</think>

<answer>A . Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)</answer>